

U8 5v5 · checked worked examples

40-minute illustration only. Confirm actual periods and substitution rules. Obtain referee permission; adapt to children's needs and record actual minutes.

Six players · fewer changes

Minutes	Playing (five children)	Resting
0–10	A B D E F	C
10–20	A B C E F	D
20–30	A B C D F	E
30–40	A B C D E	F

A/B: 40 minutes; C/D/E/F: 30 each. Total 200. Rotate full-match roles at the next comparable fixture. Optional GK: A first half; B second.

Eight players · equal 25-minute shares

Minutes	Playing (five children)	Resting
0–5	D E F G H	A B C
5–10	A E F G H	B C D
10–15	A B F G H	C D E
15–20	A B C G H	D E F
20–25	A B C D H	E F G
25–30	A B C D E	F G H
30–35	B C D E F	G H A
35–40	C D E F G	H A B

A–H: 25 minutes each. Total 200. Optional 10-minute GK turns: D, A, B, C in that order. Goalkeeper minutes count towards each total.

The FA handbook recommends equal playing time where possible, at least 50% as best practice. Competition requirements must be checked. These tables are optional editorial plans, not FA-endorsed. A fixed full-game keeper changes the outfield-time arithmetic.